

6

WRITING PYTHONIC CODE



Powerful is a meaningless adjective for programming languages. Every programming language describes itself as powerful: the official Python Tutorial begins with the sentence “Python is an easy to learn, powerful programming language.” But there’s no algorithm that one language can do that another can’t, and no unit of measurement to quantify a programming language’s “power” (although you certainly can measure the volume at which programmers argue for their favorite language).

But every language does have its own design patterns and gotchas that make up its strengths and weaknesses. To write Python code like a true *Pythonista*, you’ll need to know more than just the syntax and standard library. The next step is to learn its *idioms*, or Python-specific coding practices. Certain Python language features lend themselves to writing code in ways that have become known as *pythonic*.